

Title: SUNLIGHT TRACKING SYSTEM USING ARDUINO UNO

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Empathize

Problem identification

- ❖ Solar panels fixed at one position do not get maximum sunlight all the time.
- ❖ Sun moves from east to west → fixed panel produces less power.
- ❖ Energy efficiency reduces due to poor alignment.

User needs

- ❖ A system that automatically adjusts towards sunlight.
- ❖ Low-cost and easy-to-build solar tracking method.
- ❖ Improved solar power output without human effort.
- ❖ Works reliably throughout the entire day.

Define

Problem statement

- ❖ To design a system that detects sunlight direction using sensors.
- ❖ To rotate the solar panel using a servo or DC motor.
- ❖ To ensure the panel continuously faces the brightest direction.
- ❖ To increase solar energy absorption efficiently.

Objectives

- ❖ Sense sunlight using LDR sensors.
- ❖ Compare light intensity on left and right sides.
- ❖ Track sunlight automatically from morning to evening

Ideate

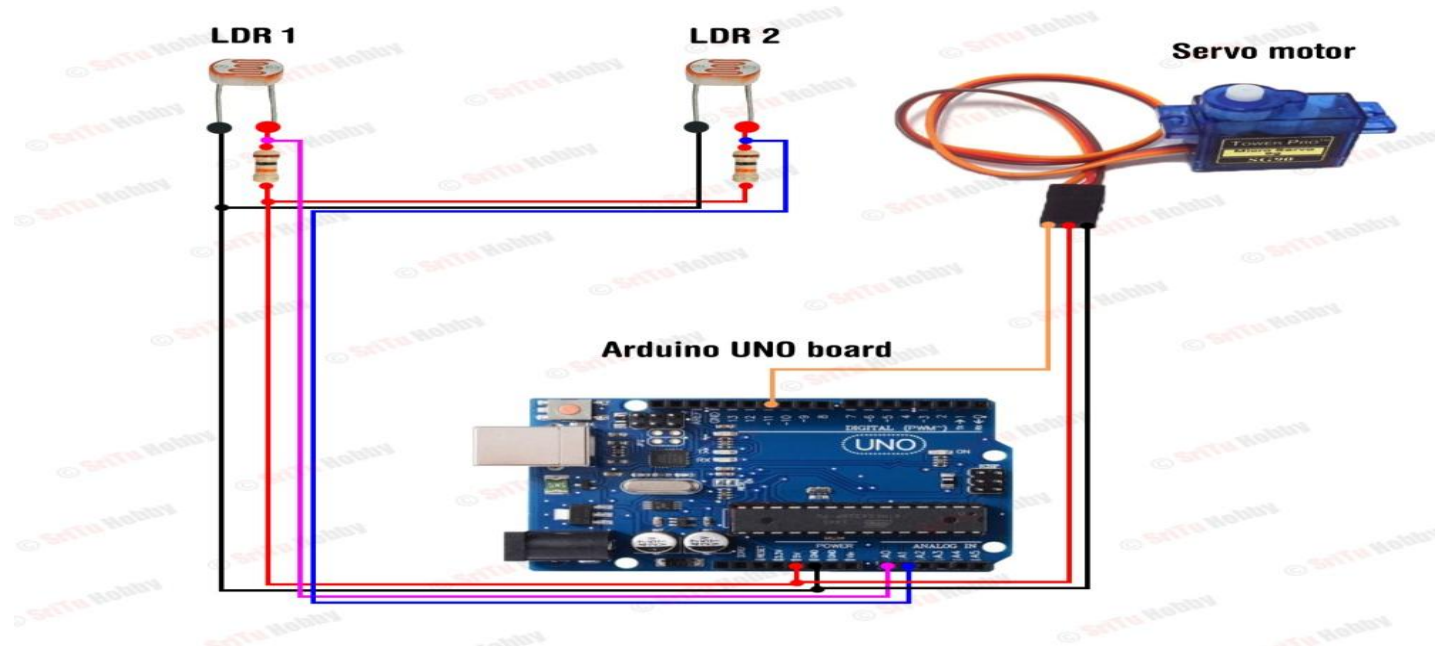
Possible solutions

- ❖ Use two LDR sensors to detect sunlight difference and rotate the panel.
- ❖ Use four LDR sensors for more accurate sunlight detection.
- ❖ Use a single-axis servo motor to follow the sun east to west.
- ❖ Use a dual-axis system to track sun movement in all directions

Concept selection

- ❖ **Arduino UNO** → easy to program.
- ❖ **Servo Motor** → precise movement.
- ❖ **Low cost** and suitable for students.

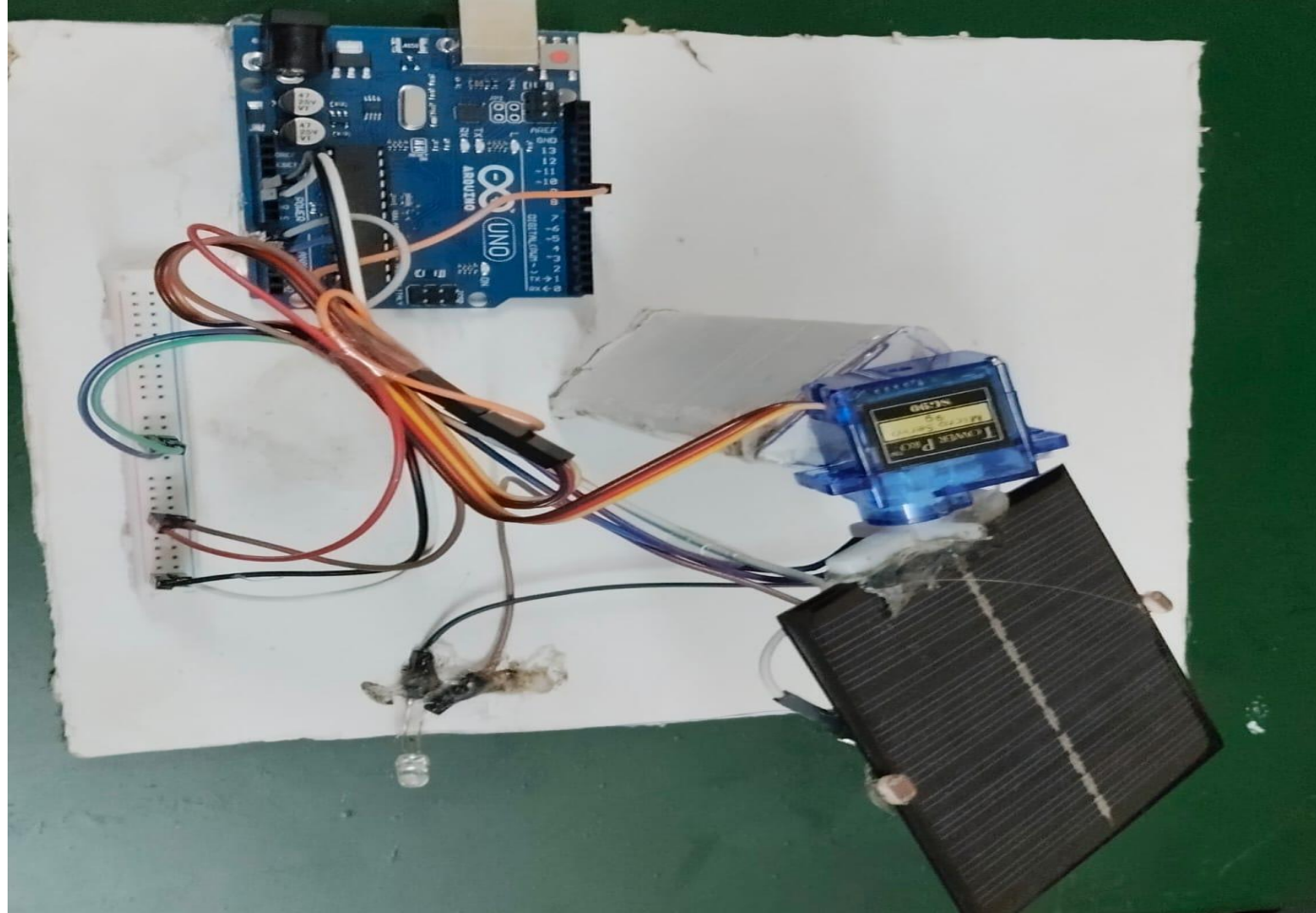
Prototype



Hardware/software details

- ❖ Arduino UNO is used as the main controller for reading sensors and controlling the motor.
- ❖ Two LDR sensors are connected to the analog pins to sense sunlight intensity.
- ❖ 10k Ω resistors are used with LDRs to form voltage divider circuits

Test



Conclusion & Future scope

- ❖ The system successfully tracks sunlight using LDR sensors and Arduino.
- ❖ It increases the efficiency of solar panels by maintaining the best angle.
- ❖ The design is simple, low-cost, and easy to implement.
- ❖ Can be upgraded to dual-axis tracking for higher efficiency.
- ❖ Can integrate IoT to monitor solar panel performance remotely.
- ❖ Can use ML/AI to predict sun position even during cloudy weather

Reference

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- ❖ Chatterjee, S., and Roy, S., “Microcontroller-based dual-axis solar tracker for renewable energy applications,” IEEE Trans. Ind. Electron., vol. 70, no. 3, pp. 2754–2763, 2023.
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Thank you